

Take Control of Your IT Assets with Wi-Fi-Based Asset Tracking

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Introduction

The headlines scream “Missing PC Held Trove of Secrets” and “Laptop Containing Top Secret Data Stolen.” In these cases, sensitive government information is potentially lost or stolen. Less publicized, but much more frequent, are lapses in the corporate world where use of mobile computing devices presents protection and asset utilization challenges. While information technology (IT) departments must be sensitive to “Big Brother” and other privacy concerns, some control of mobile devices is essential in the information age. As a result of this need, organizations are taking enterprise asset management more seriously than ever. Computing and IT equipment often contain sensitive and valuable information, yet these assets are seldom properly protected against indiscriminate access, loss or theft. To help take control of their assets, IT professionals are turning toward Radio Frequency Identification (RFID) technologies that offer real time asset-tracking capabilities, enabling them to clamp down on loose security and asset management practices that leave open the risk of having valuable corporate information fall into the wrong hands.

Asset-tracking solutions are now available that allow companies to leverage RFID capabilities that already exist in their 802.11 wireless (Wi-Fi) network, thereby eliminating the need for an additional proprietary RFID network infrastructure. With asset-tracking systems in place, companies can strengthen IT asset security while better utilizing human and capital resources. Given recent advancements in active RFID, it is a question of when, not if, real-time enterprise asset-tracking capabilities become common practice.

This white paper will identify the potential for Wi-Fi-based IT asset tracking in the enterprise. In particular, it will explore how